

air conditioner, and remote parking. The pre-timer allows you to switch on the air conditioner at a specific time of your choice, even before you would enter the car. With remote park, you can opt to remotely turn on the ignition, and use a combination of the touch interface and the physical keys to roll the car out of a tight parking spot. This mode only happens to work if you've parked your car in parallel line to other parked cars. The mode does not offer steering control.



Transitioning away from conventional car keys

Climate control

You get four-zone climate control (for all four passengers of the car), seven-step air flow adjustment, air direction control, timed and latched air recirculation, along with a host of other settings. These other settings include fragrance adjustment, along with seat ventilation to cool your seat or heat it.

Rear seat infotainment

The rear seats get their own infotainment displays, along with a remote control to operate the systems. The rear infotainment systems can choose to access content via the rear input sources, which include a CD/DVD drive, SD card, USB or aux. It doesn't support Bluetooth, which can only be enabled from the front console.

The rear HD displays are large enough to enjoy a movie on the go. You can also access drive settings and navigation, although phone settings are left out from the rear screens.

Ambient lighting and sunroofs

The BMW 740Li gets two sunroofs, front and rear, and a multi-LED ambient lighting system that allows users to choose colours either singularly or in combination with white LED accents.

The colours include red, orange, gold, yellow, magenta, blue, violet and green. The LEDs run along the dash and doors from the front to the rear, to create a nice, plush ambience. These LEDs also extend to the glass and sunroofs.

REAR SEAT AND RIDE QUALITY

The rear left seat includes adjustable recline, lumbar support, thigh support, and a full stretch out mode where the front passenger seat moves forward to give you maximum space and even



The rear screens are all about entertainment

bring out a folding foot rest. This seat also includes a massager and ventilation that can be controlled from the rear central console. The massage patterns include whole body actuation, separate massages for hip, lower back, full back and shoulder, each with controllable intensity. The seat itself has excellent

will feel any bump that is a little deep. The NVH (noise, vibration and harshness) levels are also not user refined, and the quiet cabin is often unsettled by occasional rattles and noise filtering through from outside.

DRIVING DYNAMICS

The BMW 740Li is powered by a 6-cylinder, 3-litre petrol engine that produces 326 brake horsepower and 450Nm of torque. The engine combination is formidable enough, and sees the long wheelbase limousine stretch easily upward of 170kmph on open highways despite the heavy body weight.

The power delivery is fairly linear, although aggression is largely controlled to focus on comfort. Despite the length of the saloon, the handling is fairly respectable even in corners, and the BMW 740Li has a nimble-footed excellence on highways that will please even the most discerning drivers. The steering wheel is decently weighted, although it does feel a little too light in city, considering the length and weight of the car. However, the fine leather wrapping and good grip, coupled with excellent seat customisation means that you will find your preferred driving position very easily, and this makes the car quite the driver's car as well.



Impressive handling for a car of this size

padding and support for the whole back and thigh, and even the headrest's height can be adjusted electronically. The central armrest is also quite pliant, and all of this leads to one of the most luxurious seats that a car has on offer.

However, the ride quality could certainly have been smoother. The suspension is a tad stiffer than optimum, which means that while the car does soak up smaller road abrasions, you

BOTTOMLINE

The BMW 740Li is certainly right up there with the best luxury cars on offer in India today. We only wished that the cabin was even quieter, and the audio system even better, particularly considering that it would be competing against the formidable Mercedes-Maybach S600. But, on its own terms, the BMW 740Li never fails to put a smile on your face. 